

3.6 Doing It Many Times

Loops and your first collection

WHILE - REPEAT UNTIL TOLD TO STOP



```
while (true) {  
    std::print("Friend's name: ");  
    std::string friendName;  
    std::getline(std::cin, friendName);  
  
    if (friendName.empty()) {  
        break; // empty line means we're done  
    }  
  
    friends.push_back(friendName);  
}
```

BREAK

`break` exits a loop immediately, regardless of the loop's condition.



```
if (friendName.empty()) {  
    break;  
}
```

Without it, `while (true)` would never stop on its own.

YOU DON'T HAVE TO BUILD ONE

C++ ships with ready-made collections - you don't have to build your own growable list.



```
std::vector<std::string> friends;
```

`std::vector<std::string>` is a list of strings that **grows** as you add to it with `push_back`.

Same idea as `std::string` being a ready-made collection of characters. You don't need to know how `std::vector` works inside to use one.

LOOPING OVER THE COLLECTION



```
std::println("\nYou added {} friend(s):", friends.size());  
for (const std::string& friendName : friends) {  
    std::println(" - {}", friendName);  
}
```

A range-based **for** visits every element, one at a time - no manual indexing required.

3.6 / SEE IT RUN

[SCREENSHOT]

WATCH IT GROW, ONE PUSH_BACK AT A TIME

Step into the loop and open your IDE's variable/locals view - watching `friends` gain an element on each iteration is the clearest way to see a `std::vector` actually grow.

[SCREENSHOT]

Next: 3.7

Saving and Loading Files